

The Renaissance

Beginning in the 1400s, there were big advances in art and science in Europe. Artists were inspired by ancient Greek and Roman works of art, which had been rediscovered. That is why this period is called the Renaissance, meaning "rebirth." New ideas were spread quickly thanks to the invention of the printing press in Germany.

KEY (1430-1530)



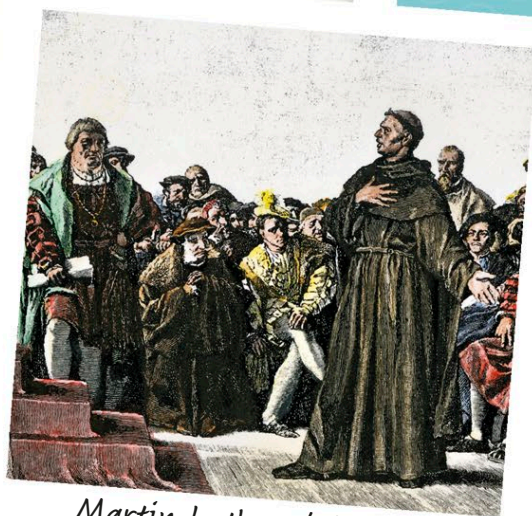
Borders

The borders that separated countries.



Printing press

The printing press was used to print books, which spread ideas quickly. Presses were set up in many cities.



Martin Luther defending his ideas in 1521

In England, composers wrote music for the lute, a stringed instrument.



Lute

ENGLAND

London

Erasmus was a famous Renaissance writer and thinker.



Erasmus

Antwerp

Ghent

Paris

The church divides

In 1517 Martin Luther, a German priest, challenged many of the teachings of the Catholic Church. As a result, Luther's followers founded new Protestant churches.

New view of Earth

The church taught that Earth was the center of the universe. But in the early 1500s, the Polish astronomer Nicolas Copernicus argued that Earth and the other planets moved around the sun.

The astrolabe was used by Portuguese explorers to find their way at sea.

ATLANTIC OCEAN

FRANCE

Madrid

Astrolabe

Lisbon

SPAIN

PORTUGAL

In the 1400s, Portuguese ships set off to explore the coast of Africa.



Portuguese ship

Model universe with Earth at the center

